

Primary Source Annotation 3: Imperial Advertisement

Due: Friday, October 2 at 11:59 PM

Value: 30 points

Format: 600-word visual-source annotation

Purpose

Analyze how commercial imagery made empire appear natural, desirable, modern, or benevolent.

Your task

- Choose one approved sourcebook image: a Pears' Soap imperial advertisement, a British Empire Exhibition poster, a French colonial postcard, or a Japanese South Manchuria Railway tourism poster.
- Describe composition, text, gaze, scale, color hierarchy, and the relationship between commodity and people before interpreting.
- Identify the intended consumer and the imperial relationship the image normalizes or conceals.
- Compare the advertisement with one course text from a colonized writer and explain how the second source changes the reading.

Submit

- 600-word annotation PDF with a captioned thumbnail or stable archive link.
- Chicago citation for image and comparative source.

Important note

Do not reproduce an image if its archive record prohibits reuse. A stable link and detailed visual description are acceptable.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Context	7	Accurately situates creator, audience, place, and historical moment.
Close reading	9	Analyzes two specific features of the source with careful evidence.
Interpretation	8	Makes a defensible claim and distinguishes inference from fact.
Limits and citation	6	Names silences or limits and supplies a complete Chicago citation.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.